Day 10 (stop 1 of 2) - Devil's Punch Bowl, Oakridge Drive, New Mountain Road

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Iroquoia section · hike 14 · Devil's Punch Bowl, Stoney Creek

6.0 km / 3.7 mi	~1.8 h	1.4 km new	54 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside Parking: On Leslie Dr west of New Mountain Rd, just north of the railway bridge. Provides access to the New Mountain Road Side Trail. Google Maps. **Free**

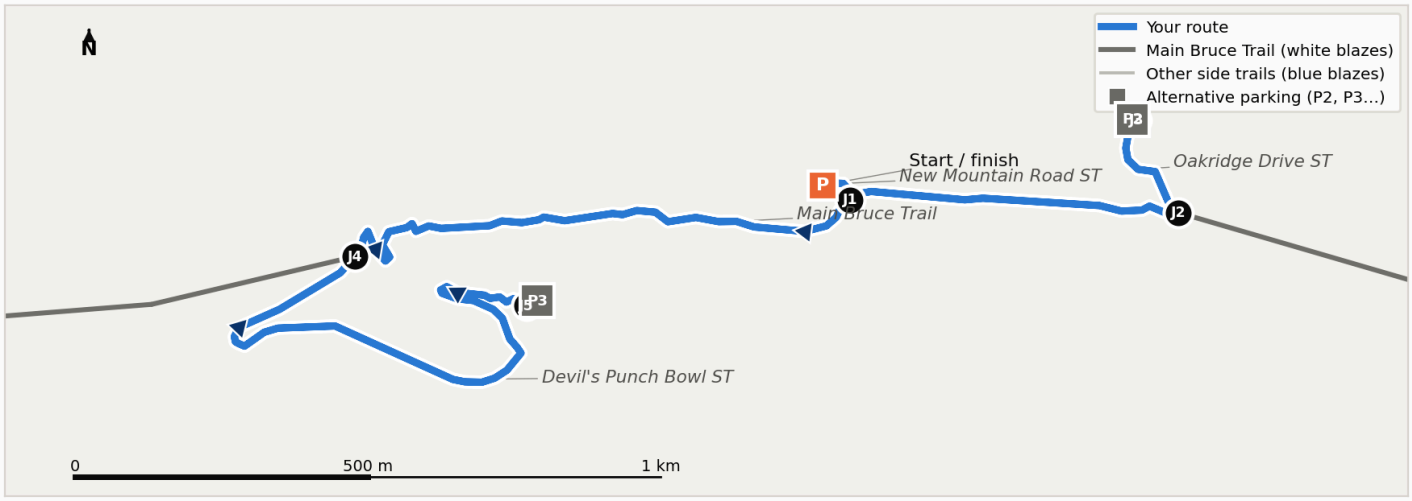
Navigate: import *day10a_hike014.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Devil's Punch Bowl Side Trail (1.2 km); Oakridge Drive Side Trail (0.2 km); New Mountain Road Side Trail (0.1 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 10 (7.3 mi of hiking, about 129 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 15, 3.5 mi from At the intersection of the Adam Dopko Access Trail and Main St W at Casablanca Blvd.

Route map

Day 10 (stop 1 of 2) | 6.0 km (3.7 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on Leslie Dr west of New Mountain Rd, just north of the railway bridge. The Hamilton Conservation Authority (HCA) lot at the Punch Bowl itself charges $8.50 a day (pay at the machine); this route starts from the free roadside spot instead.
- **Devil's Punch Bowl Side Trail:** HCA says the side trail runs down a section of Ridge Rd before joining the main Trail, so keep Zappy close and watch for traffic there.
- **The Punch Bowl:** A 33.8 m ribbon falls (upper) and a 5.5 m lower falls in a deep gorge. Lookouts show bands of red Queenston shale, grey shale and limestone, with views over Stoney Creek and Hamilton Harbour. A lit steel cross stands beside the gorge.
- **Cautions:** HCA warns that loose rock falls often and without warning. Stay behind the fences; going to the bottom of the falls is prohibited. Below the escarpment the Bruce Trail is the only permitted route, and you can see the lower falls safely from it. Keep well back from the rim.
- **Main Trail and short side trails:** The main Trail links the New Mountain Road and Oakridge Drive side trails to the Punch Bowl. A club hike description mentions escarpment-edge walking with some hills and uneven footing. No details were found for the two short side trails.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Roadside Parking: On Oakridge Dr off Green Rd, south of King St map	Free	0.8	0 m	Oakridge Drive
P3	Devil's Punch Bowl Conservation Area: Enter from Ridge Rd, east of Centennial Parkway map	Paid (amount not confirmed)	3.8	0 m	Devil's Punch Bowl

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 1.7 km / 1.0 mi, covering New Mountain Road, Oakridge Drive. **Outing 2** from P3 (Devil's Punch Bowl Conservation Area: Enter from Ridge Rd, east of Centennial Parkway; Paid (amount not confirmed)): 2.3 km / 1.4 mi, covering Devil's Punch Bowl. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside Parking: On Leslie Dr west of New Mountain Rd, just north of the railway bridge. Head east on the blue-blazed New Mountain Road Side Trail. The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.0	0.0	J1: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
0.6	0.4	J2: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Oakridge Drive Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
0.8	0.5	J3: End of the Oakridge Drive Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (Roadside Parking: On Oakridge Dr off Green Rd, south of King St). Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.0	0.6	J2: Turn sharp right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.6	1.0	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the New Mountain Road Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
2.6	1.6	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Devil's Punch Bowl Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.7	1.7	Heads-up: The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
2.9	1.8	Heads-up: The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
3.8	2.4	J5: End of the Devil's Punch Bowl Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (Devil's Punch Bowl Conservation Area: Enter from Ridge Rd, east of Centennial Parkway). Turn around and retrace your steps.
4.1	2.6	Heads-up: The next 0.5 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
4.7	2.9	Heads-up: The next 0.3 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
4.9	3.1	J4: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.0	3.7	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed New Mountain Road Side Trail, heading north-west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off ahead.) The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
6.0	3.7	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Hamilton Conservation Authority, Hiking the GTA and the Grand Valley Trails Association.